

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Plural devotional chronology

6th-9th c. -> Alvar and Nayanar devotional corpora in the south

11th-13th c. -> Vedanta schools and early north Indian Sufi networks

13th-14th c. -> Chishti and Suhrawardi institutions expand

15th c. -> Kabir, Nanak and regional vernacular devotional currents

late 15th-16th c. -> Chaitanya, Surdas, Meera and wider literary publics

RULE: multiple currents overlap; no single movement starts everywhere.

MUST REMEMBER: Bhakti and Sufi traditions were internally diverse across region, language, social location, doctrine and institution.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Bhakti field without flattening

SAGUNA -> devotion through embodied divine forms and narratives

NIRGUNA -> devotion to a formless absolute and critique of fixed representation

TEMPLE / SECT -> ritual, institution, pilgrimage and inherited authority

POET-SAINT / SONG -> oral performance, vernacular memory and community

VEDANTA -> Ramanuja, Madhva, Nimbarka and distinct philosophical grammars

CAUTION: these categories overlap and vary by region and period.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Sufi vocabulary and transmission

SILSILAH -> authorised chain of spiritual transmission

PIR -> guide | MURID -> disciple | KHALIFA -> authorised successor

KHANQAH -> discipline, teaching, hospitality and social contact

SAMA -> devotional audition, accepted and debated in different settings

ZIYARAT -> shrine visitation and remembered saintly presence

FANA -> effacement of ego before God, not a political programme.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Chishti network and social credibility

AJMER: Muinuddin Chishti

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DELHI: Bakhtiyar Kaki -> Nizamuddin Auliya -> Nasiruddin Chiragh

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AJODHAN: Baba Farid and Punjabi memory

MECHANISM -> service + hospitality + counsel + sama + relative court distance

TRAP: popularity does not prove a centrally planned conversion campaign.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Chishti-Suhrawardi comparison

CHISHTI

Ajmer, Delhi, Ajodhan

poverty/service ideal

relative distance from office

khanqah credibility

RULE: neither order was uniform, morally pure or socially identical.

SUHRAWARDI

Multan and Punjab

readier acceptance of grants

greater possibility of official connection

learned and institutional resources

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Southern roots and Vedanta paths

ALVARS -> Tamil Vaishnava devotion and hymn traditions

NAYANARS -> Tamil Shaiva devotion and temple-linked memory

RAMANUJA -> qualified non-dualism and prapatti

MADHVA -> dualism and enduring difference between God and soul

NIMBARKA -> difference-and-non-difference formulation

LESSON: Bhakti is emotional devotion plus philosophical articulation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Northward transmission with source caution

SOUTHERN DEVOTIONAL CORPORA + PILGRIMAGE + TEACHER NETWORKS

- > regional languages, temples, sects and remembered guru lineages
- > RAMANANDA tradition and diverse disciple lists
- > northern Rama devotion, nirguna critique and vernacular publics

CAUTION: hagiographic genealogy is not a dated attendance register.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Kabir critique and corpus method

CRITIQUE -> empty ritual, inherited rank and sectarian certainty

LANGUAGE -> accessible vernacular and memorable couplet

THEOLOGY -> nirguna devotion with vocabulary crossing social worlds

CORPUS -> oral circulation and variant later compilations

EFFECT -> ethical challenge and community formation, not abolished caste

LIVE BRIDGE -> modern Kabir memory cannot authenticate medieval wording.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Nanak householder ethic

ONE DIVINE REALITY + REMEMBRANCE

- > HONEST WORK + SHARING + HOUSEHOLDER DISCIPLINE
- > critique of empty ritual, hierarchy and renunciatory monopoly
- > ethical community rooted in ordinary social life

CAUTION: separate Nanak's moment from later Sikh institutions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Chaitanya public devotion

KRISHNA DEVOTION + EMOTIONAL SURRENDER

- > KIRTAN: collective singing, movement and embodied participation
- > BENGAL-PURI network: pilgrimage, disciples and remembered charisma
- > broader affective public and literary-cultural transmission

TRAP: public participation did not automatically erase hierarchy.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Saguna and nirguna devotion, and Chishti and Suhrawardi silsilas, cannot be collapsed into one reform programme.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Bhakti-Sufi interaction without merger

SHARED FIELD -> towns, crafts, vernaculars, music, pilgrimage and service

SIMILARITIES -> love, guru/pir relation, ethical critique and accessible idiom

DIFFERENCES -> theology, scripture, law, ritual and institutional lineage

CONTACT -> translation, vocabulary, technique and shared audiences

SAFE FRAME -> parallel exchange or symbiosis with boundaries

TRAP: similarity is not proof of direct borrowing or doctrinal identity.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Composite culture describes negotiated interaction; it must not erase conflict, hierarchy or sectarian boundaries.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 10 answer spine

OPEN -> plural devotional and mystical currents, not two monoliths
SUFİ -> vocabulary + order + khanqah + political posture
BHAKTI -> southern roots + doctrines + poet-saints + vernacularisation
COMPARE -> shared social field while preserving theological differences
QUALIFY -> inclusion, caste, gender, corpus and hagiographic limits
CLOSE -> enlarged ethical and cultural vocabularies without ending hierarchy.